Week 6: Group Activity Worksheet

Stop Motion Workshop — Your Shape Story Comes Alive

Tutorial Objective: Continue your **Week 2 shape story** and turn it into a short stop motion animation with the **Life Lapse** app. Explore how **movement**, **rhythm** and **balance** work over time.

Links to Subject Outcomes: Apply design principles (movement and balance: repetition, rhythm, direction, visual weight); apply prototyping skills to explore design ideas.

App download: stopmotionapp.com/scan-to-download-life-lapse

How This Tutorial Runs

Activity	Mode
Briefing, app check, animation basics	Whole class
Part A & B – Continue the story and plan the shots	Individual
Part C – Build the set and cut the shapes	Individual
Part D – Shoot the animation in Life Lapse	Individual
Part E – Edit, add sound and export	Individual
Part F – Class screening and peer feedback	Whole class
Part G – Blackboard upload	Individual

Before Class (Homework Check)

☐ **Life Lapse installed** on your phone (iOS or Android) through the link above
☐ Opened the app once and allowed **camera** and **storage** permissions
☐ Phone charged (at least 70%) and **at least 2 GB** free storage
☐ Brought your **Week 2 storyboard and characters**

Materials Checklist

☐ Coloured paper in 3+ colours; cut triangles, rectangles and circles in **several sizes**
☐ A3 paper or card as the background (the "stage")
☐ Scissors, Blu-Tack, masking tape
☐ Phone stand / tripod, or a stack of books to hold the phone **completely still**
☐ Desk lamp (optional, for even light)

Student Information

Field	Details
English Full Name	
Student ID	
Tutorial Class	
Date	
Phone OS	☐ iOS ☐ Android

Week 2 story title:

Animation Basics (Reference)

Principle	What It Means	How to Do It with Paper Shapes
Timing	Number of frames for an action	More frames = slower; fewer frames = faster
Spacing	Distance moved between frames	Small steps (2–5 mm) = slow; big steps (10–20 mm) = fast
Ease in / ease out	Objects speed up and slow down gradually	Start with tiny steps, get bigger, end with tiny steps
Anticipation	A small move before the main action	Move back slightly before jumping forward
Squash & stretch	Shows weight and impact	Swap in a slightly flatter or taller cut-out on impact
Arcs	Natural movement follows curves	Move along a pencil-marked curved path
Hold	A pause for emphasis	Shoot the same pose for 6–12 frames

Part A: Continue the Week 2 Story

A.1 Recap

My Week 2 story in one sentence:

Feedback from Week 2 that I want to use:

A.2 What Happens Next?

Choose one approach: ☐ **Sequel** (what happens after the ending) ☐ **Extended version** (add scenes inside the story) ☐ **New twist ending**

Story Stage	What Happens in the Animation
Opening *(recall the original world)*	
New event / problem	
Climax	
New ending	

Part B: Plan the Animation

B.1 Frame Calculator

Target length: 15–30 seconds (plus 2-second title and 2-second credits).

Setting	My Choice
Frame rate *(8, 10 or 12 fps recommended)*	_____ fps
Story length	_____ seconds
Total frames needed *(fps × seconds)*	_____ frames

Example: 20 seconds × 10 fps = 200 frames. At about 15 seconds per frame, that is roughly 50 minutes of shooting, so plan carefully!

B.2 Shot List

Shot	**Duration (s)**	**Frames**	**Action (what moves, from where to where)**	**Animation Principle**	**Design Principle *(movement / balance / emphasis / unity)***
Title	2		Title card	Hold	
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					
Credits	2		Name, ID, music credit	Hold	
Total					

B.3 Animation Storyboard

Sketch the key frame of each shot and draw **arrows** to show the movement path.

Part C: Build the Set

Step	Action	☐
1	Tape the background paper **firmly** to the desk so it cannot move.	☐
2	Fix the phone **directly above** the stage (top-down view) using a stand or books. It must not move for the whole shoot.	☐
3	Tape small corner marks so you can reset the stage if it gets bumped.	☐
4	Use even light. Avoid windows (sunlight changes) and keep your hands' shadows out of the frame.	☐
5	Cut all characters, including **variations** (squashed / stretched versions, different sizes for zooming).	☐
6	Use small pieces of Blu-Tack under shapes so they don't slide or blow away.	☐
7	Take a test photo and check that the whole stage is in frame with no desk edges showing.	☐

Part D: Shooting in Life Lapse

D.1 App Set-Up

Step	Action	☐
1	Open Life Lapse → create a **new project** → name it `W06_[YourName]`.	☐
2	Select **Stop Motion** mode (manual capture, one frame per tap).	☐
3	Turn on the **ghost / onion-skin overlay** to see the previous frame.	☐
4	**Lock focus and exposure** (tap and hold on the screen) so the brightness doesn't flicker.	☐
5	Turn on **Airplane / Do Not Disturb mode** so calls don't interrupt.	☐
6	If available, use a remote shutter or the timer so tapping doesn't shake the phone.	☐

D.2 Shooting Routine (repeat for every frame)

1. **Move** the shape a small amount. Use the ghost overlay to judge the spacing.
2. **Remove your hands** completely from the frame.
3. **Capture** one frame.
4. **Check** quickly by playing back every 10–20 frames.

Shooting Progress Tracker

Shot	Frames Planned	Frames Shot	Playback Checked	Re-shoot Needed?
Title			☐	☐
1			☐	☐
2			☐	☐
3			☐	☐
4			☐	☐
5			☐	☐
6			☐	☐
Credits			☐	☐

D.3 Behind-the-Scenes Documentation

Take **at least 3 photos** of your set-up, cut-outs and shooting process for your Visual Journal.

☐ Photo 1 — Full set-up (phone, stand, stage, light)
☐ Photo 2 — All cut-out characters and variations
☐ Photo 3 — You in action / a mid-shoot moment

Problems during shooting and how I solved them:

Part E: Edit and Export

Step	Action	☐
1	Set the **playback speed / frame rate** in Life Lapse to match your plan (B.1).	☐
2	Delete bad frames (hands visible, blurry, flicker). Duplicate frames to create holds.	☐
3	Add **music or sound effects** from the app library or royalty-free music. Record the credit.	☐
4	Add a **title card** (story title) and **credits** (name, student ID, music credit).	☐
5	Export as **MP4, 1080p** if available. Save to your phone's gallery.	☐
6	Watch the final video once more from start to finish.	☐

If the free version adds a watermark, that is acceptable. Do not crop it out.

Final video length: _____ seconds **Final frame rate:** _____ fps

Part F: Screening and Peer Feedback

Ask two classmates to fill in one row each after watching your animation.

Reviewer Name	Is the movement smooth? *(1–5)*	Is the story clear? *(1–5)*	Best moment	One suggestion
	/5	/5		
	/5	/5		

Reflection

How did movement change the meaning or emotion of your shape characters compared with the still storyboard?

Which animation principle made the biggest difference? Show an example (shot number).

Part G: Blackboard Submission

Upload Checklist

☐ **Final animation** (MP4)
☐ Story continuation (Part A), frame calculator and shot list (Part B)
☐ Animation storyboard (B.3)
☐ 3 behind-the-scenes photos (D.3)
☐ Peer feedback and reflection (Part F)

File Requirements

Item	Requirement
Video	MP4, 1080p if possible, 15–30 s (plus title and credits)
Document	One PDF with Parts A–F and photos
File Names	`W06_[EnglishFullName]_[StudentNumber].mp4` and `W06_[EnglishFullName]_[StudentNumber].pdf`
Location	Blackboard → SSHD2382 → Week 6 → Stop Motion
Deadline	Before the start of the Week 7 tutorial

If the video is too large for Blackboard, upload it to OneDrive / Google Drive / YouTube (unlisted), and put the share link on the first page of your PDF. Check that the link opens without a login.

Additional Notes

References & Resources

Record music / sound credits, tutorials you watched and any inspiration: